

Star Ratings Strike Room — Centene Corporation

Motion: Star Ratings cliff-edge (new-logo) · **Product angle:** Queue Optimizer, with Back Office Optimizer for the operations-integration seats · **Target:** Centene Corporation · **Status:** send-ready, run as sequenced

Why Centene: a confirmed non-customer and one of the largest eligible cliff-edge books in the universe, an overwhelmingly sub-4.0 Medicare book with a set of contracts sitting right at the bonus line. UnitedHealthcare, Humana, CVS/Aetna, Kaiser, Elevance, Molina, and Scan Health are current-customer exclusions and out of the new-logo motion.

Merge fields: `{{sender}}` is the sending rep's name, used in every signature and in each voicemail intro ("this is `{{sender}}` with Intradiem"). Optional `{{contracts_at_3_5}}` is the confirmed count of Wellcare contracts at 3.5 from Clay; it can drop into Jesse Lewis's Touch 1 if you want the hard number, otherwise the copy stays count-safe.

Account snapshot

Centene's Medicare book runs largely under the Wellcare brand, and by public CMS 2026 data the majority of it sits below the 4.0 Quality Bonus Payment line: a portfolio average around 3.39 and roughly a fifth of members in 4-star-or-better plans. Centene has moved fast on this, from about 1% of members in 4-plus-star plans in 2025 to near 18 to 20% in 2026, with a Stars turnaround the CEO has put on the record. The part that is left is the expensive part: the contracts sitting right at the 3.5 line, a half star from the bonus, where the fastest QBP recovery lives. The single largest sub-4.0 block is Wellcare by Fidelis Care, roughly 69,000 members at 3.0 overall, a bigger climb but the biggest single prize. Centene knows its exact picture better than we do.

Item	Value	Source
Forgone QBP across the sub-4.0 book	~\$76M (estimate)	Modeled from CMS 2026 ratings + enrollment
Contracts at the 3.5 cliff (half star from bonus)	a cluster of near-line Wellcare contracts	CMS 2026 Star Ratings file
Largest single sub-4.0 block	Wellcare by Fidelis Care, ~69k members, 3.0 overall	Public CMS 2026 release
Public Stars trajectory	~1% (2025) to ~18-20% (2026) of members in 4+ plans	CMS 2026 release + Centene disclosures
Customer status	Confirmed non-customer, eligible	Internal

Timing, why now: CMS released the 2026 ratings on Oct 8 2025, setting the PY2027 bonus. The measurement for the next ratings cycle is open across 2026 right now. The operational window to move a half star before the next cliff is this year, not next, and the fastest money is the contracts already sitting at 3.5.

Buying committee (real contacts, pulled and validated in Clay)

#	Name	Title	Tier	Email status	Angle
1	Corey Taliaferro	VP, Health Plan Operations (Carolina Complete Health)	A	Enriching (email drafted, fires on validation)	QO + BOO
2	Cyrus Hoseini	VP, Operations	B	Verified	QO + BOO
3	Justin Hedrick	VP, Operations and System Integration	B	Verified	QO + BOO
4	Matthew Tran	Sr Director, Member Experience and Innovation	B	Verified	QO
5	Jesse Lewis	Sr Director, Medicare Operations	B	Verified	QO + BOO

LinkedIn: Taliaferro /in/coreytaliaferromba/ · Hoseini /in/cyrus-hoseini-b739209/ · Hedrick /in/justin-hedrick-3bb08b6/ · Tran /in/matttran/ · Lewis /in/jesse-lewis-44445815a/

Emails: Hoseini cyrus.hoseini@centene.com · Hedrick justin.hedrick@centene.com · Tran matthew.tran@centene.com · Lewis jesse.lewis@centene.com · Taliaferro pending validation (Clay enriching)

Messaging level: company-level narrative for the enterprise ops seats (Hoseini, Hedrick, Taliaferro, Tran); contract-specific only for Jesse Lewis, Sr Director of Medicare Operations, the one seat where naming the Wellcare cliff directly is defensible. Everyone else hears the enterprise version so we do not overclaim knowledge of who owns which contract.

What reps can and cannot say

Say: Centene's forgone-QBP exposure, always as an estimate from public CMS data; Centene's public Stars trajectory (roughly 1% to near a fifth of members in 4-star-or-better plans, 2025 to 2026); Wellcare by Fidelis Care at roughly 69,000 members and 3.0 overall, from the public CMS 2026 release; and what Intradiem is, Dynamic Workforce Orchestration across the contact center and the back office.

Do not say: any Intradiem ROI, lift, percentage, or customer-outcome number. None is verified in the Value Repository yet. The copy carries weight from the prospect's own math and their own public record, not from claims we cannot source.

Cadence and committee choreography

Every contact runs the same five-touch, multi-channel cadence across business days:

- **Touch 1 (Day 1):** Email 1
- **Touch 2 (Day 2):** LinkedIn connection request
- **Touch 3 (Day 4):** Voicemail, plus a LinkedIn message the same day
- **Touch 4 (Day 6):** Email 2 (second angle, the closing measurement window)

- **Touch 5 (Day 9):** Breakup email

Entry is staggered so a consistent half-star narrative surfaces inside Centene ops within one week without looking like a blast: Hoseini, Hedrick, and Taliaferro enter on Day 1; Lewis and Tran enter one day behind them. The bodies, hooks, and CTAs are distinct per contact, so if two of these leaders compare notes they see five different angles on the same problem rather than one template. Where an email is at deliverability risk, let the LinkedIn touch carry the opener so the thread does not go cold. Taliaferro's Email 1 is drafted and queued; it fires the moment Clay validates his address.

Sequences

1. Corey Taliaferro — VP, Health Plan Operations (Tier A) • QO + BOO

Touch 1 (Day 1) — Email (*queued, fires on address validation*) Subject: the half star lives on the floor

Corey, running Carolina Complete Health's operations, you already know the half star between a near-line contract and the 4.0 bonus is not won in the scorecard. It is won on the floor, in the weeks volume runs hardest and service either holds or slips right when the measures are watching. Across Centene's sub-4.0 book that gap models to roughly \$76M in forgone Quality Bonus Payments from public CMS data, and the fastest of it is the contracts already sitting at 3.5.

Intradiem runs workforce orchestration across the contact center and the back office, acting on real-time conditions so quality does not dip under load. I can show you where a plan your size typically loses that half star before the next measurement window closes. Worth twenty minutes?

{{sender}}

Touch 2 (Day 2) — LinkedIn connection request Corey, I work the operations side of health plan Stars, the gap between what the scorecard measures and what happens on the floor when volume spikes. Given you run Carolina Complete Health's ops, would value connecting.

Touch 3 (Day 4) — Voicemail Corey, this is {{sender}} with Intradiem. I sent you a note on the half star between Centene's near-line contracts and the 4.0 bonus, and why most of it is decided on the operations floor during peak weeks. I can show you where a plan your size usually loses it before the next window closes. I am at [number], or reply to the email. Thanks Corey.

Touch 3 (Day 4) — LinkedIn message Corey, left you a voicemail too. Short version: the fastest Star money for Centene is the contracts already at 3.5, and whether they clear is an execution question during peak weeks. I can show you where that gap opens for a plan your size. Twenty minutes?

Touch 4 (Day 6) — Email Subject: the window is more than half gone

Corey, the reason this is a now question and not an October one: the measurement that sets the next rating is running across this year and is already more than half spent. Every peak week without the operational piece in place locks more of the next cliff in before the ratings ever publish. The contracts at 3.5 are the ones where that still swings your way if execution holds.

That is what Intradiem is built to hold steady under load. Twenty minutes and I will walk the specific points in a peak week where that half star is usually won or lost.

{{sender}}

Touch 5 (Day 9) — Email Subject: leaving it here

Corey, I will stop here. One parting thought: the contracts at 3.5 are the cheapest half star Centene will ever buy back, and the window to move them is the peak weeks between now and the next measurement close, not the October release. When that lands on your desk, the workforce-execution angle is where I would start. Glad to help whenever it is useful.

{{sender}}

2. Cyrus Hoseini — VP, Operations (Tier B) • QO + BOO

Touch 1 (Day 1) — Email Subject: the last stretch of the Stars climb

Cyrus, Centene did the hard early part of the Stars climb, from about 1% of members in 4-star plans last year to near a fifth this year. The part left is the expensive part: the contracts sitting right at 3.5 where a half star still stands between them and the 4.0 bonus. By public CMS data that gap is worth roughly \$76M in forgone Quality Bonus Payments across the sub-4.0 book.

Most of that half star is execution, whether service levels and back-office turnaround hold when volume runs hardest, not something a scorecard fixes after the fact. Intradiem orchestrates the contact center and back office off real-time conditions so it does. Twenty minutes on what holding the next half point actually costs versus what it returns?

{{sender}}

Touch 2 (Day 2) — LinkedIn connection request Cyrus, reached out on the operational side of the last stretch of Centene's Stars climb, the contracts at 3.5 that are the expensive part. Would value connecting.

Touch 3 (Day 4) — Voicemail Cyrus, this is {{sender}} with Intradiem. I emailed you on the last stretch of the Stars climb, the near-line contracts where a half star still stands between them and the bonus, and how much of that rides on service levels holding during peak weeks. Twenty minutes on what holding it costs versus returns? I am at [number]. Thanks Cyrus.

Touch 3 (Day 4) — LinkedIn message Cyrus, left a voicemail too. The heart of it: the contracts at 3.5 are an execution question more than a scorecard one, and that is where the next half point comes from. Worth a short call on what it takes to hold them?

Touch 4 (Day 6) — Email Subject: where the next half point comes from

Cyrus, the first eighteen points came from work Centene has already done. The next ones are harder, because the contracts still under the line are where the gap opens under load: conditions change, the workforce response lags, the measures catch it. The measurement window is running now, so that lag is being priced into the next cliff week by week.

Intradiem closes that lag automatically, which is what keeps the climb going instead of stalling at the expensive part. Twenty minutes to walk what that looks like at your scale?

{{sender}}

Touch 5 (Day 9) — Email Subject: last note

Cyrus, I will leave it here. One thought worth keeping: the climb from 1% to 18% was the affordable part, and the contracts at 3.5 are where the curve gets steep, exactly where execution under load decides it. When finishing it becomes a priority, that is the angle I would start from. Glad to help whenever the timing is right.

{{sender}}

3. Justin Hedrick — VP, Operations and System Integration (Tier B) · QO + BOO

Touch 1 (Day 1) — Email Subject: where the half star actually moves

Justin, with the system-integration side of your role you will see this fast. The half star between Centene's near-line contracts and the 4.0 bonus lives in the gaps between systems and staffing: conditions change in real time, the workforce response lags, and service quality dips right when it counts toward the rating. Across the sub-4.0 book that gap models to about \$76M in forgone Quality Bonus Payments from public CMS data.

Intradiem sits in that gap, orchestrating the contact center and back office off live signals instead of after the report. Twenty minutes on where the integration-to-staffing lag is widest and what closing it is worth on the contracts nearest the line?

{{sender}}

Touch 2 (Day 2) — LinkedIn connection request Justin, reached out on Centene's star cliff, specifically the systems-to-staffing gap where the near-line contracts are won or lost. Would value connecting.

Touch 3 (Day 4) — Voicemail Justin, this is {{sender}} with Intradiem. I sent a note on the half star across Centene's near-line contracts and how much of it opens up in the gaps between systems and staffing during peak weeks. That is the part we automate. Twenty minutes on where that lag is widest? I am at [number]. Thanks Justin.

Touch 3 (Day 4) — LinkedIn message Justin, left you a voicemail too. Short version: the half star on the near-line contracts lives in the lag between real-time conditions and the workforce response, and closing that lag is what Intradiem does. Happy to show the integration view. Twenty minutes?

Touch 4 (Day 6) — Email Subject: the lag is being priced in now

Justin, one point that makes this a this-year question. The measurement that sets the next rating is running across 2026 now, so every week the systems-to-staffing lag goes unclosed is a week baked into the next cliff before the ratings publish. The contracts at 3.5 are where that still swings your way if the response keeps pace with conditions.

Intradiem automates that response off live signals, so the leverage works for you instead of against you. Twenty minutes and I will show the integration view on the contracts nearest the line.

{{sender}}

Touch 5 (Day 9) — Email Subject: closing the loop

Justin, I will stop here. One parting thought: the integration-to-staffing lag is the least visible part of the half star and the most fixable, and it is being scored right now. When it surfaces as an operations-and-systems priority, that is squarely where I spend my time. Glad to pick it up whenever it is worth your while.

{{sender}}

4. Matthew Tran — Sr Director, Member Experience and Innovation (Tier B) · QO

Touch 1 (Day 1) — Email Subject: member experience and the half star

Matthew, the measures that decide a half star, the ones tied to how members experience service, sit closest to your seat. Across Centene's sub-4.0 book the gap to the 4.0 bonus models to roughly \$76M in forgone Quality Bonus Payments from public CMS data, and the contracts at 3.5 are where it is most recoverable.

The experience gap usually opens under load: hold times climb, follow-ups slip, and the member feels it in exactly the interactions the rating captures. Intradiem orchestrates the workforce in real time so the experience holds when volume

does not cooperate. Twenty minutes on which experience measures look most exposed heading into the next scoring window?

{{sender}}

Touch 2 (Day 2) — LinkedIn connection request Matthew, sent a note on the member-experience side of Centene's star cliff, the measures that slip first under load. Would value connecting.

Touch 3 (Day 4) — Voicemail Matthew, this is {{sender}} with Intradiem. I emailed you on the member-experience measures inside Centene's half-star gap and how they slip under load, exactly when the rating is watching. Twenty minutes on which ones look most exposed for you? I am at [number]. Thanks Matthew.

Touch 3 (Day 4) — LinkedIn message Matthew, left a quick voicemail too. The gist: the experience-linked measures are where the half star is won, and they are the first thing to slip when volume spikes. Intradiem keeps them steady under load. Short call on where it is tightest for you?

Touch 4 (Day 6) — Email Subject: the measures are being scored right now

Matthew, the reason this is worth a look now rather than in October: the experience-linked measures that set the next rating are being scored across this year, in the live interactions happening today, not on release day. Every stretch where the experience slips under load counts toward the next cliff before anyone sees the number. The contracts at 3.5 are where holding it steady still moves the rating.

That real-time hold is what Intradiem is built for. Twenty minutes and I will show how the orchestration piece protects the experience measures specifically.

{{sender}}

Touch 5 (Day 9) — Email Subject: last one

Matthew, I will leave it here. One thought to keep: the experience measures are the first to slip under load and the slowest to recover once a scoring window closes, which is why holding them in real time is worth more than fixing them after. When that becomes a focus, that is the seam I work. Glad to help whenever the timing fits.

{{sender}}

5. Jesse Lewis — Sr Director, Medicare Operations (Tier B) · QO + BOO — the one seat cleared for contract-specific messaging

Touch 1 (Day 1) — Email Subject: the Wellcare contracts closest to 4.0

Jesse, since you own Medicare operations I will be specific. By our estimate from public CMS data, the Wellcare book carries roughly \$76M in forgone Quality Bonus Payments across its sub-4.0 contracts. The fastest to recover is the set sitting right at 3.5, a half star from the bonus; the largest single block is Wellcare by Fidelis Care, around 69,000 members at 3.0 overall, a bigger climb but the biggest prize. You will know the exact picture better than I will.

On the contracts closest to the line, the gap is largely execution: whether service and back-office turnaround hold during peak weeks. Intradiem orchestrates the contact center and back office off real-time conditions so they do. Twenty minutes on the specific Wellcare contracts nearest the line and which measures still move them?

{{sender}}

Touch 2 (Day 2) — LinkedIn connection request Jesse, reached out on the Wellcare contracts closest to the 4.0 line. Would value connecting here too.

Touch 3 (Day 4) — Voicemail Jesse, this is {{sender}} with Intradiem. I sent a note on the Wellcare contracts closest to the 4.0 line, the 3.5 set that is the fastest bonus money, plus Fidelis as the largest block, and how much of it comes down to execution holding during peak weeks. Twenty minutes on the ones nearest the line? I am at [number]. Thanks Jesse.

Touch 3 (Day 4) — LinkedIn message Jesse, left you a voicemail too. Short version: the half star on the Wellcare contracts nearest 4.0 is an execution question, and closing that gap in real time is what Intradiem does. Twenty minutes on the ones nearest the line?

Touch 4 (Day 6) — Email Subject: the next rating is being set now

Jesse, one point on timing for the Medicare book specifically. The measurement that sets the next rating is running across this year, so the Wellcare contracts nearest 4.0 are being decided right now, in the peak weeks between now and year end, not on the October release. Every week execution holds is a week toward clearing the line; every week it slips is priced into the next cliff.

Intradiem makes that execution consistent under load. Twenty minutes and I will walk the Medicare-operations view on the contracts nearest the line.

{{sender}}

Touch 5 (Day 9) — Email Subject: leaving it here

Jesse, I will stop for now. One parting thought: the 3.5 contracts are the cheapest half star on the Wellcare book to buy back, and Fidelis is the biggest single prize behind them, both decided in the peak weeks happening now. When protecting them becomes a priority, the workforce-execution angle is where I would start. Glad to help whenever the timing is right.

{{sender}}

Objection quick-handles

"We already have WFM." Right, and WFM tells you what should happen with staffing. This is about what happens in the moment conditions change, the automated response between forecast and floor. It sits alongside WFM, it does not replace it.

"We are already improving our Stars." You are, and the public numbers show it, from about 1% of members in 4-star plans to near a fifth in a year. The contracts still under the line are the expensive part of that climb, where the gap opens under load and a scorecard cannot close it after the fact. That is the piece we would help hold, so the progress does not stall at the hardest contracts.

"Wait for the October ratings." The ratings in October report a measurement window that is closing now. Waiting means the next cliff is already set before anyone acts. The half star moves during the year, not on release day.

"Send me information." Happy to. The one thing a deck will not answer is which of your contracts are closest to the line and most execution-sensitive, which is a twenty-minute conversation. I will send the overview and we can find time if it is worth it.

Claims basis

Every dollar figure here is an estimate modeled from public CMS 2026 data and labeled as such in the copy, with the humility that Centene knows its exact picture better than we do. Centene's Stars trajectory and the Wellcare by Fidelis

Care figure come from public CMS releases and Centene's own disclosures. No Intradiem ROI, lift, or customer-outcome claim appears anywhere in this copy.